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RAYS

A Brighton's Publication

About RAYS

Rays is a tri-monthly newsletter published by the Brighton International School. Brighton is situated near Vidhan Sabha in Raipur (C.G). Rays is a compilation of articles by students of Brighton aiming to promote literary zest amongst the students.

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A PASSION FOR BOOKS: AN INSIGHTFUL INTERVIEW WITH MRS. REENASHUKLA, LIBRARIAN AT BRIGHTON INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL



Library is often considered the heart of a school, nurturing young minds and fostering a love for reading. At Brighton International School, our librarian, **Mrs. Reena Shukla,** has been an integral part of this journey for the past 13 years. We had the privilege of interviewing her to gain insights into her experiences and the unique features of our school library.

Q. How long have you been working as a librarian at Brighton International School?

Ans. I have been working as a librarian at Brighton International School since **2012, and I have completed 13 years.** Over the years, I have truly enjoyed my role and take great pleasure in fostering a reading culture among students.

Q. What do you enjoy the most about your role as a librarian?

Ans. I love encouraging students to explore different books and write book reviews. My goal is to instill a strong reading habit in students and help them discover books that spark their imagination and curiosity.

Q. What criteria do you use to select books for the library, and what are some of the most popular books among students?

Ans. When selecting books, I focus on storybooks with pictures that attract young readers, as I believe reading habit should be inculcated from childhood. For senior students, I consider their preferences and also maintain a wishlist where students can suggest books they would like to see in the library. Currently, graphic novels like Demon Slayer are the most popular among students.

Q. How do you encourage students to develop a reading habit?

Ans. To make reading enjoyable, I have introduced a theme-based library, where students can explore a new collection of books every month. This variety keeps their interest alive and helps develop a lifelong love for reading.

Q. How does the Brighton International School library stand apart from others?

Ans. Our library is unique in many ways. It not only provides access to a vast collection of books but also **engages students in interactive activities** like book narration and review writing. To encourage reading, we have a **reward system-students earn stars for writing reviews, and once they collect 15 stars, they receive a "Reader's Badge."** This recognition is a moment of pride for them, and their achievements are displayed on the notice board, motivating others to participate.

Through her dedicated efforts, Reena ma'am has transformed our school library into a vibrant and engaging space where students can **discover, learn, and grow.** Her passion for books and reading continues to inspire us all.



Interviewed by -
Divyansh Maheswari,
Vaibhav Gupta, Grade - IX



ATTENDING SCHOOL EVERY DAY IS THE FIRST STEP TOWARDS SUCCESS



Our principal always has a way of making feel school as a place of opportunities. With her inspiring words she reminds us how important discipline is in one's life. She made us believe that there is someone who truly wants us to succeed. I am the one who got motivated.

Our school's system strongly encourages 100% attendance by creating this award which I received at the end of the year. Throughout the session we get to engage in fun and interactive events such as special assemblies, class events and extra-curricular activities where I always participate and couldn't afford to remain absent. My parents helped me in waking up on time, having breakfast and go to school with a happy and positive mind.

But it is not that easy there are speed breakers for me; It is sometimes missing socks mystery when I wasn't able to find then the uncooperative button" which broke at the last minute, but, thanks to my mom who stitched it for me with the speed of light and I was saved. At times I missed my school bus but the desire to be present everyday made my father dropped me on time whenever it was required. These incidences made me disciplined; I decided that I will prepare my school bag and uniform always on time.

The joy of achieving the 100% attendance milestone outweighs the moments; the day I got the award on the stage the effort was worth, proving that consistency always pays off.

Trisha Soni, Grade - VII (A) 100% Attendance



I Aarahan, during last academic year, in class 7, I made sure to attend school every single day. It was a commitment and I was determined, I knew that my presence every day is really important to achieve my goal.Being regular is tough task and waking up early was another challenge. On cold mornings, it felt so desiring to stay in blanket instead of getting up to go to school. On hot days, I felt drained just thinking about the long hours at school. But I knew that missing school would mean missing valuable lessons. Despite the weather, I made sure to get up and attend school regularly. A big challenge I faced was balancing school with my cricket practice. My practice session fall from 2:45 PM to 5:45 PM, and sometimes I felt like I didn't have enough time for everything. In fact, I even missed many family functions and keep going. Despite the difficulties, attending school every day has been a valuable experience. The day I received award on stage, my hard work paid me off and now I am charged for another year of 100% attendance expedition.

Aarahan Mahapatra, Grade - IX (A)



I have been this honest and consistent on this tedious journey for the past 7 years and achieved the milestone of 100% attendance and faced many problems, even got scolded for plans that got cancelled before even shaping-up and the sole reason you can guess would be my persistence. I remember the days when I had 103◦ fever but tried to manage with medicine instead of missing school.

Once I had an argument with my parents because I was neither ready to miss the school nor ready to stay in my grandmother's house as my parents were supposed to attend a family wedding but finally one of them couldn't. It's not just me who compromised but my parents, my family too supported me in my 100% attendance journey.

It was always easy and simple choice to not miss my favorite uncle's wedding or my cousin's birthday party to enjoy the best of the moments, gatherings, food and what not, but the thing that kept me motivated throughout these years was my yearly certificate and that hope of one award / medal. You know, I'm one of the earliest bus pickups at 5:55 am, whenever I missed my bus, my father had to drop me 25 km, all the way from home to school. Sometimes even I felt to just drop this record but It's hard to maintain this record but once you achieve it, you can't be prouder enough to cherish the moment & you feel it's worth being disciplined and persistent.

Anshika Jha, Grade - VIII (E)

THE JOURNEY OF ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE



As I stood at the starting line of my academic journey in Class VIII, I felt a mix of nerves and excitement. The finish line, represented by the Academic Excellence Award, seemed distant, requiring immense energy, hard work, and motivation to reach. Just like an athlete training for a big race, I had to discipline my mind, push through obstacles, and stay focused on my goal.

My journey was not without its ups and downs. There were moments of laziness and exhaustion, but I persevered. I learned that consistency was key, studying 1-3 hours daily, and attending classes diligently. This approach made achieving excellence manageable, even enjoyable.As a teenager, I believe in balancing academics with enjoyment. "Masti" (fun) is essential, but it shouldn't compromise my studies. By prioritizing and managing my time effectively, I can have fun and excel academically. This balance is crucial, and I'm committed to maintaining it.When asked who inspires me, I proudly say it's myself. My future self is my driving force. Whenever I feel demotivated, I envision my dreams and aspirations, and I'm reminded of how proud I'll be when I achieve them.My journey to academic excellence wasn't without its lighter moments. I recall my first attempt at night studying during mid-term exams. I thought I'd cracked the code, but I ended up falling asleep at my desk and waking up with a sore neck. I quickly learned that night studying isn't my forte. Winning the Academic Excellence Award has been a dream come true. Every time I see the trophy, I'm energized and motivated to work hard for the next academic session.As I look back on my journey, I'm reminded that success is a continuous process. It's not just about achieving a goal; it's about growing, learning, and improving every day.

Pragya Deshmukh, Grade - X

"Success doesn't come from what you do occasionally; it comes from what you do consistently". The belief in the importance of persistence, time management and consistency made me excel in academics. I feel very proud for what I have achieved today and receiving the academic excellence award was no less than a dream for me. I always believe that time management is the only key to success. Everyone in this world gets 24 hours a day but success depends on how you utilize it. To achieve success you must have a clear goal of your interest and you must be ready to defeat all the adverse situations that will be a hindrance to achieve your goal. We must avoid distractions by creating a dedicated goal, prioritizing self-study, taking short but regular breaks between studies and staying focused. I focused mainly on subjects like Mathematics and Science which definitely led to an increase in my percentage. While studying, I always fix a specific time limit for each chapter that I need to study. Balancing studies and other activities was honestly a very big task for me. This was only possible due to the people around who were constantly motivating me. This is the beginning of what I have accomplished and this award inspires me to continue striving for excellence and pushing the boundaries of what I can achieve. Remember "Every minute you waste doing nothing remember that someone is getting smart somewhere."



MISHIKA DEHERI, Grade - IX

CLEAN RIVER

When I was in Varanasi, I visited the banks of the holy river Ganga and what I witnessed was extremely distressed. The river was dirty, polluted with multiple plastic wrappers, flowers and other kinds of waste thrown by the visitors. I was taken aback by what I had seen and it made me think that even though we call the river “sacred” or “holy”, still it is treated as a trash. It was very painful to see as it was, the devotees of Ganga who are doing it. The cultural and religiously important river faces a lot of environmental challenges like industrial waste, domestic sewage, agricultural runoff and lack of waste management.

Historically, most civilizations settled around river like the Indus Valley Civilisation because the rivers were very important and still are for our survival, the rivers are our lifeblood and this reason is enough for not polluting it. The beautiful river that always shone in it’s glory, is now a dull shadow of it’s past self.

The government has contributed into this issue through several projects like Namami Gange Program but we must understand it is our responsibility too to conserve the river and raise awareness about the issue. Since we are the one to contribute in polluting it. We should take it as an obligation to do our small part in making the Ganga, the symbol of natural beauty like it used to be.

Let’s join hands to protect our own Ganga Maa from pollution!

Mannat Vidhani, Grade - X

MAHAKUMBH – THE ANCIENT CULTURE



The **Mahakumbh Mela** is one of the most ancient and a grand religious festival in India, which happens in every 144 yearsdeeply rooted in cultural and spiritual tradition, Kumbh is held every 12 years at four sacred locations—Prayagraj (Allahabad), Haridwar, Ujjain, and Nashik—this gathering is considered the largest congregation of pilgrims in the world. The event follows an astrological cycle, determined by the position as of Jupiter, the Sun, and the Moon, making it a significant occasion in Hinduism.

The origins of the Mahakumbh Mela can be traced back to Hindu mythology, particularly the legend of the **Samudra Manthan** (churning of the ocean). According to the scriptures, when the gods and demons churned the ocean to extract **amrit** (the nectar of immortality), a few drops of it spilled at these four locations. This divine connection is why millions of devotees believe that taking a holy dip in the sacred rivers during the Mahakumbh cleanses them of sins and paves the way for **moksha** (liberation from the cycle of rebirth).

Beyond its religious aspects, Mahakumbh Mela has historically served as a **spiritual and intellectual hub**. Ancient texts like the **Puranas** mention the significance of the festival, and travelers such as **Hiuen Tsang** (7th century) have documented its grandeur. It is a place where saints, ascetics, and scholars from various sects gather to engage in spiritual discourse, Vedantic teachings, and philosophical debates. Over centuries, it has remained a crucial space for the exchange of **knowledge, traditions, and cultural values.**

In the modern era, Mahakumbh Mela is not just a religious event but also a celebration of India’s **rich heritage and spiritual diversity.** It attracts people from across the globe, offering them a glimpse into ancient Hindu traditions, rituals, and the timeless wisdom of the sages. The festival stands as a testament to the continuity of India’s cultural legacy, making it an unparalleled spectacle of faith, devotion, and unity.

Anannya Agrawal, Grade - IX

PREPARING FOR THE BIG LEAP: MY BOARD EXAM JOURNEY

As I sit down to write this article, I am filled with a mix of emotions - excitement, nervousness, and determination. With the board exams just around the corner, I am focusing all my energy on preparing for this crucial milestone.

My daily routine has undergone a significant transformation. I wake up early, feeling refreshed and ready to tackle the day. After a quick breakfast, I dive into my study schedule, which is carefully planned to ensure I cover all the syllabus. My mornings are spent reviewing notes, practicing problems, and clarifying doubts.

In addition to self-study, I am also attending extra classes at school, where our teachers are providing valuable guidance and support. Their expert advice and encouragement have been instrumental in boosting my confidence.

As the exams approach, I am feeling more focused and determined. I know that the next few weeks will be challenging, but I am ready to put in the hard work and perseverance required to succeed.

I would like to take this opportunity to thank my teachers, family, and friends for their unwavering support and encouragement. Your motivation means the world to me.

To my fellow students, I would like to say that it's time to stay committed, stay focused, and believe in ourselves. We have come a long way, and with collective effort, we can achieve our goals

Let's do this !

A Board Exam Aspirant

FENCING-: A SPORT OF DISCIPLINE, FOCUS, AND STRENGTH

Fencing is a sport that requires discipline, concentration, agility, and strength. It is a combat sport in which two athletes use swords to attack and defend against each other, aiming to score points by striking their opponent.

My fencing journey began in 2018, when I was just seven years old and studying in grade II. I represented Raipur, Chhattisgarh, and specialized in the sabre event. Over the years, I have participated in numerous tournaments at the district, zonal, state, and national levels.

I have been fortunate to win five gold medals and three bronze medals in state-level championships. My passion for fencing has taken me to various cities, including Rajahmundry, Bhilai, Nashik and recently Jammu, where I competed in the national championship.

While I have not yet won a medal at the national level but playing nationals increased my desire for the medal. I am working hard to improve my performance. Despite facing health challenges and a busy tournament schedule, I ensure that I practice for 2-3 hours daily. Each practice session begins with stretching exercises, followed by intense training that includes bouts, footwork, and targeting drills. Coach plays an essential role in my development, constantly guiding and encouraging me. His support motivates me to improve my skills and strategize effectively against my opponents.

Fencing has become more than just a sport for me. It is my passion. I am determined to pursue it as my career and will continue to work hard to achieve my goals.

Riddhima Singh, Grade - IX



AN INSPIRING STORY OF PERSEVERANCE AND PASSION!



"My boxing journey was a transformative experience that tested my limits, yet yielded profound rewards. Through relentless training, unwavering discipline, and sacrifices, I emerged as a resilient and determined athlete. My parents were my rock, offering unconditional support and encouragement. Unlike my father's own experiences, where his passion for sports was met with disapproval from his parents, mine was nurtured and propelled forward.

Surprisingly, the most daunting challenge wasn't the training at 4 AM training sessions, but the constant travel across states. I have a weak immune system so I always use to get sick whenever there's a weather change which always hindered me during training session. It was a common occurrence to get fist in the face or a red eye. Despite the obstacles, I persevered, fueled by my passion for boxing and the support of those around me."

My mentor Shubham Sir played a pivotal role in shaping my journey. His dedication was inspiring – he not only motivated me but also selflessly devoted time to refine my skills and prepare me for the Nationals. I remember when I was disappointed to play national with the same person from whom I lost earlier in the states finals but this was my time to fight back and finally won in second round by RSC(Referee Stops Contest), declaring I won the match at Haryana. Oh! I was on top of the world. Now working hard for matches ahead and giving my best for sports and study to manage both hand in hand.

Archit Jadeja, Grade - X

BOXING (I DISCOVERED MY KNOCKOUT PASSION)



For me, boxing has been more than just a sport. It's a way to push beyond my limits build strength and learn about resilience both in and out of the Ring. I started my boxing on 2023 with my parent's support. My father forced me to take this sport as it will help me for my self-defense, mental toughness and focus even he told me Mary Kom's story. I was not talking to my father for more than a week but when I started playing, gradually I developedinterest I was very afraid of the matches but my parents helped me to build courage and win. Although I didn't win the state level but won everyone's heart later I won bronze medal in States I was happy with it but not satisfied my next match was in West Bengal. It was my first trip without my parents but my coach helped me to be strong. I won gold medal and was promoted to National to be held at Haryana. I was very nervous although I lost in my Nationals but learned a lot which will help me for further competitions.

I had so much fun in this national journey when I went to West Bengal for my boxing match, instead of practicing boxing, I used to take badminton from the sports room and play there. I can say I love sports. People think that boxing is a game of fights, but they are wrong, it is a game of determination and courage. It helps students to be confident.

Arshil Azim Khan, Grade - VII

AN ADVENTURE TRIP TO KANHA NATIONAL PARK

Our adventure began with a bus ride from Raipur to the breathtaking Kanha National Park. As we climbed, we could only hear laughter and chatter. Everyone trying to find their seats,eager to sit next to their dearest friends. The excitement was too much to handle.We talked about everything from what we had packed to what we might see in the jungle.It was a funfilled experience.Our second day began before dawn as we woke up at 4 a.m. for the much-awaited jungle safari. Sleepy but excited, we quickly dressed and hopped into the open Gypsy, shivering slightly in the crisp morning air. As we got closer to the jungle, our guide joined us, sharing amazing insights about the wildlife and how they spot animals so effortlessly. We kept waiting but despite our patience, the tiger remained unseen. However, we did spot various deer, including the barking deer, which, as our guide explained, lets out a dog-like bark to warn other animals of danger.

After returning to the hotel, we geared up for the rain dance-a carefree, joyful experience filled with laughter and splashes. Lunch was followed by a short rest, preparing us for an evening of fun. We played badminton and other games until dusk, when a group of tribal dancers arrived. Their beats and energetic moves were mesmerizing, and soon, we found ourselves dancing along with them. The night ended with a delicious dinner and tired smiles as we drifted into sleep &eager for another day of adventure. Today it was the final day,the third day. We all were sad but also happy to see our parents after 2 days. Early morning, 7 o'clock we all woke up and left for breakfast and then an amazing river walk which was really interesting. As we reached there,we saw a deer drinking water near the river we all were mesmerized looking at the scene many of the children collected shells, rocks and leaves of the Sal tree. The river walk was tiresome, so we requested our guide to cancel the village walks for us.Instead we went for shopping not in a mall but in small stalls.Itwas really fun.Many of us bought items for us and our family.This was the last thing of that day after this we reached back to our hotel, freshened up and got back to our buses and left for our home. It was really fun staying with our friends for such a long time.At last we thanked our school for arranging this unforgettable trip for us.

Alya Kaur Alag, Grade - VI





मेरे शिक्षक

छोटी सी मैं गुड़िया हूँ,
जादू की मैं पुड़िया हूँ।
ब्राइटन में पढ़ना मुझे लगता है अच्छा,
यहां सभी शिक्षक देते हैं ज्ञान सच्चा।
सभी शिक्षक खेल-खेल में हमें पढ़ाते,
नए अंदाज में पाठ सिखाते।
बोर हमें नहीं होने देते,
हर दिन कुछ अनोखा करते।
हाथ जोड़कर सबको प्रणाम,
रोशन करुँगी आपका नाम।

स्वरा डागा, कक्षा–II (B)

